

Chapter 28-7

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Perhaps because of encountering Mrs. Qi, Liang Shi actually had nightmares that night.

In the dream was a dim background, and that enclosed room again. She entered in her own current state and saw the young original owner.

The original owner had been crying, but when she heard the sound and turned around, seeing Liang Shi, she actually smiled foolishly.

That smile was eerie.

It gave Liang Shi goosebumps all over.

The undeveloped little girl wasn't particularly attractive, but her body showed obvious signs of having been abused.

Liang Shi crouched down and asked her: "Did someone hit you?"

She didn't speak, just smiled.

Then the room door opened, and Mrs. Qi with her jade bracelet walked in. She was still wearing that blue-green qipao, and she was pulling along another little girl.

Mrs. Qi called out: "Jiaojiao."

Mrs. Qi made Jiaojiao lie on the bed, then made the little girl stand there and watch.

Mrs. Qi raised her hand and pinched Jiaojiao's body, asking her: "Are you obedient?"

Jiaojiao cried and said: "Obedient... Mommy, please don't hit me anymore..."

Mrs. Qi smiled coldly: "If you're obedient, why did you tell on me to daddy? Daddy doesn't want you anymore."

Jiaojiao could only cry "wuu wuu wuu."

Mrs. Qi looked at the little girl standing on the ground: "Don't look. You were also sent here by your mommy."

Mrs. Qi touched her hair: "I just said our Jiaojiao needed a companion, and she sent you over."

The little girl cowered.

Mrs. Qi said: "Your mommy told me I could discipline¹ you however I wanted."

Then Mrs. Qi walked over, and the little girl backed away step by step, showing a terrified expression.

Mrs. Qi smiled and asked: "Where should I hit first?"

Suddenly, she kicked the little girl in the stomach.

Liang Shi watched in horror and cried out: "No!"

She reached out to stop it, but her body was ethereal, passing through the dim dust.

The lights suddenly turned on.

Liang Shi abruptly opened her eyes and touched her forehead—it was covered in cold sweat.

Just now... was that the original owner's childhood?

Did Qiu Zimin hate the original owner that much?

She was just a child—what kind of deep hatred could there be?

Liang Shi was still shaken when Xu Qingzhu beside her asked: "Did you have a nightmare?"

She nodded: "A little."

They had returned early tonight, and having both fallen into water, they had gone to bed early.

There was still a quilt separating them in the middle.

Xu Qingzhu had slept for a while then woken up, planning to use the bathroom, when she discovered Liang Shi was having nightmares.

That's when she turned on the light to wake Liang Shi up.

Liang Shi covered her violently beating heart as Xu Qingzhu handed her a glass of warm water: "Are you okay?"

Liang Shi nodded: "I'm fine."

It was just that the feeling from earlier was too real—so real it was as if she had experienced it herself.

This way, neither of them could sleep.

Xu Qingzhu sat there and opened her computer while Liang Shi felt bored.

After spacing out for a while, Liang Shi suggested: "Should we watch a movie?"

Xu Qingzhu was wearing glasses and working on a proposal. Hearing this, she glanced at Liang Shi, seeing she was still somewhat frightened, and nodded: "Should we go downstairs?"

"We can watch in the bedroom. I had the butler fix the projector." Liang Shi said as she turned on the projector and got out of bed to rummage through the drawer.

She had also had the butler purchase some DVDs.

On top was a yuri² film—*The Handmaiden*.

Liang Shi glanced at it—the keywords were listed as same-sex and suspense.

When she was still in that other world, people had recommended this movie to her. She had always said she wanted to watch it, but had put it off several times.

Now finding this was quite novel, so she asked Xu Qingzhu: "Is this okay?"

Xu Qingzhu could be called a movie desert³.

She didn't really watch movies, so she left it entirely up to Liang Shi.

Liang Shi put the DVD into the drive, then got back into bed.

Footnotes:

¹ Discipline - The Chinese term used here (調教) has connotations of training or disciplining with potential abusive undertones, which is why it appears particularly sinister in this context.

² Yuri - A genre focusing on romantic relationships between women, equivalent to Girls' Love (GL).

³ Movie desert - Chinese slang meaning someone who rarely watches movies or has very limited knowledge about films.

Author's Note: [If any author's notes were present in the original text, they would be translated here]